

CPUs mounted on paper

A young Swedish company is printing really cheap chips. The company, Cypak, has technology to mount a very small microprocessor, which it created, on paper (or inside a credit card), as well as a technique to print sensors, switches, and very short-range antennae on the same paper, using special conductive inks.

Cypak's CPU is designed to take input from a variety of sensors. Cypak's technology currently costs a dollar or more per unit. That's pretty cheap for a computer, but still too expensive for everyday products.

Gateway connects gadgets to the laptop

Gateway has launched a Laptop that is bundled with a memory card reader. This helps in using several Flash Memory cards which are used by MP3 players and digital cameras. The reader forms a part of the revamped version of Gateway 400L model laptop computer, which includes a 1.8 GHz Intel Celeron Processor, 256 MB DDR RAM, 30 GB hard drive and a 15-inch XGA display panel.

The laptop is set to sell for a promotional price of \$999 after a \$100 rebate. The Memory Card reader can read several popular Memory Card formats such as Memory Stick, Secure Digital (SD), IBM Microdrive, Compact Flash, Multimedia Card Memory and SmartMedia. Future models will carry the memory card reader as an optional \$50 upgrade from a floppy drive.

Running Linux on iPod?

In recent weeks, Bernard Leach, a computer enthusiast has managed to get Apple's iPod to run parts of a version of Linux—but at the cost of some of the device's key features. He was able to get Apple's digital music player to run basic parts of the uClinux version of the Linux operating system.

However, several of iPod's key features were sacrificed in running Linux. Leach's Linux-equipped iPod could play audio or display simple



graphics, but it could not use the iPod's scroll wheel, remote control, or the FireWire port—the iPod's only means of exchanging data with other devices. And although the Linux-equipped iPod could play audio, even its MP3 playback did not live up to expectations.

However, Leach is very excited about the whole project and has high hopes for a penguin-powered version of the iPod.

Kon-fabulous Mac tool

In the mid-1990s, two programmers, Arlo Rose and Greg Landweber, launched an interface revolution with Kaleidoscope, a tool that allowed everyone to customise the look of their computer. It became very popular since many users designed their own funky interfaces which they shared freely with others over the Internet.

Rose has now teamed up with engineer Perry Clarke to release a new piece of software to help people create

little custom applications to do almost anything they can think of—from automatically gathering news headlines to ordering items over the Internet.

Called Konfabulator, it is a JavaScript runtime application for Mac OS X that runs little custom programs called Widgets. These Widgets can be almost anything, from games to system monitors, stock tickers, utilities or Web services. Konfabulator is extremely slick and uses Apple's Quartz rendering engine to give the Widgets beautiful, detailed graphics and silky-smooth animation.

It is priced at around Rs 1,250 and includes a digital clock, a To Do list, a calendar and an application for viewing the current weather.

snapshot

Worldwide sales of PCs will touch **147.5 million units in 2003**

Source: IDC



heroes

HP: Recycling Ahoy!
Hewlett-Packard has launched a new program that will give consumers up to \$50 towards the purchase of new products in exchange for recycling their old equipment, from any manufacturer, through HP's recycling service. HP may either donate or recycle the old computers.

GNOME and KDE
With the launch of the new edition of GNOME, Linux desktop managers GNOME and KDE are looking at common specifications to give increased interoperability, thus benefiting Linux users on the whole, and encouraging the trend of Linux desktop adoption by businesses and governments.



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Floppy Drives

The demise of the floppy drives seems imminent after Dell announced that it will stop shipping them as standard accessories on high-end Dimension computers from next month, instead offering a 16 MB portable USB drive as a replacement.

Cyber Warfare

US President George Bush has signed secret orders that authorise the right to wage cyber warfare should America be attacked, and invade foreign networks to shut down all essential services including power supply and phones.